



Even Keel

Our December 2026 link — what changes for you, in plain English

A proposal for discussion · CEA link · 26 weeks · code EK-26-H1

The short version

Five things to take away if you remember nothing else

35h

**the contracted
week, as now**

no extra hours

5

**most days
in a row**

up to 6 · today 7

14

**full weekends
off a year**

today 10 · 7 in 26

8 of 15

**shift times you
already work**

7 new ones

30 min

**off every
closing shift**

Sundays: 45 min

Same hours, shorter closers, weekends off never more than five weeks apart, and one shift time most weeks.

Why the link has to change

Nobody is changing it for the sake of it



A new timetable in December 2026

More trains, at new times — the link has to follow them.



More of us on the link

It grows from 20 weeks to 26, so six more colleagues join it.



New staffing levels

At least 10 on a Sunday, and more at the open and the close. We also aim for 14 on a Saturday.



The ticket office in fixed pairs

Two early and two late, on the same shifts, every day.

The change is coming whatever we do — the question is which version we want.

Will I work more?

The first thing everyone asks

	Today	Even Keel
Contracted hours a week	35h	35h
Contracted days at work a week	4.20	4.19
Contracted days at work a year	219.0	218.6

No. The same 35-hour week on average and no more days; weeks run from 24h 30m to 41h 30m (today 25h 10m to 43h 50m), and two more of the days fall on a Saturday.

Will my basic pay change?

Basic pay follows your contracted hours

	Today	Even Keel
Contracted hours a week	35h	35h
Saturdays a year, at time and a quarter	26	28
Sunday overtime to share — each, a year	21	20

No. The same 35-hour week — plus about two more Saturdays at time and a quarter.

Will my shifts be longer?

Every closing shift gets shorter — the average goes up about two minutes

	Today	Even Keel
Weekday closer — starts 15:45, not 15:15	8h 40m	8h 10m
Saturday closer — starts 15:15, not 14:45	9h 10m	8h 40m
Sunday closer — starts 15:15, not 14:30	8h 55m	8h 10m
Longest shift anywhere	9h 10m	9h 00m
Average shift	8h 14m	8h 16m

Every closing shift is 30 to 45 minutes shorter; the longest early turn goes from 8h 30m to 9h 00m, and nothing runs over 9 hours.

Will I finish late more often?

5 more a year after 23:00 (44, today 39); 16 more at 22:00 or later (94, today 78)

	Today	Even Keel
Finishing at 23:00 or later — each, a year	39	44
Finishing at 22:00 or later — each, a year	78	94
Starting at 06:20 — each, a year	62	60
Shortest gap between two shifts	12h 30m	14h 35m

More people stay on after 22:00 under the December staffing; five more a year after 23:00, four to the Saturday close.

Will I know the times?

15 shift times in all — 8 of them you already work



You work these today (8)

- 06:20–14:00
- 06:20–14:20
- 06:20–14:50
- 07:15–15:45
- 11:00–19:30
- 14:00–22:30
- 14:30–22:00
- 15:15–23:55



New times (7)

Weekdays

- 14:45–22:30 — a new late, ending with the ticket office
- 15:45–23:55 — the closer, 30 minutes later than 15:15

Saturday

- 06:20–15:00 — a new early, 8h 40m
- 07:45–16:45 — a new early, 9 hours

Sunday

- 15:15–23:25 — the closer, 45 minutes later than 14:30
- 09:00–18:00 — a new early, 9 hours
- 14:30–22:30 — the ticket-office late

Fewer shift times than today (15, not 18) — and several of the new ones are shorter versions of today's lates.

Rest and weekends

The biggest improvement over today

	Today	Even Keel
Full weekends off, about a year	10	14
Most days worked in a row	7 (up to 9)	5 (up to 6)
Rest-day breaks of two days or more	13 of 17	22 of 26
Shortest gap between two shifts	12h 30m	14h 35m
Weeks on one turn, no early-late switch	7 of 16	18 of 21

14 full weekends off a year, at most five weeks apart, and one shift time in 18 of 21 weeks.

Your 26 weeks at a glance

The green bars are the full weekends off; where you start is decided later



■ all earlies ■ all lates ■ mixed earlies and lates ■ cover week — four duties placed later ■ full weekend off (Saturday and the Sunday after)

14 full weekends off a year, never more than five weeks apart; the longest run of one kind is 5 weeks of lates.

Booking leave

What 14 days of annual leave buys you, with Sundays off

	Today	Even Keel
Days off in a row — best place to book	30	28
Days off in a row — on average	23.4	23.4
Days off in a row — worst place	19	20
Leave for four full weeks off, at best	14	15

Best stretch 28 days, not 30; four full weeks off costs 15 days' leave, not 14. Average the same, worst a day better.

More staff on the floor

More people rostered every day, at the open and the close

	Today	Even Keel
On duty on a weekday	11–12	15
On duty on a Saturday / Sunday	10 / 8	14 / 10
Fewest rostered on the floor	2	3
Avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota	4 (up to 5)	0

At least three rostered on the floor, and no avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota.

The honest trade-offs

Nothing is free — here is what it costs

Seven new shift times to learn

Several of them are shorter versions of the lates you already work today.

Shifts about 2 minutes longer on average

That is what keeps days at work to 219 a year or fewer on the same 35 hours.

Four weeks off: 15 days' leave, not 14

Best 14-day stretch 28 days, not 30; average as today, worst a day better.

Two more Saturdays a year

28 a year each, today 26 — fourteen on a Saturday, shared across 26 lines.

A few more late finishes

44 a year each at 23:00 or later (today 39) — four to the close on a Saturday.

Still a proposal

Your views count before a link is chosen, and who goes on which line is not decided.

None of these is hidden: each one is on the full proposal sheet too.

At a glance

Today's roster and Even Keel, side by side

	Today	Even Keel
Contracted hours a week	35h	35h
Contracted days at work a year	219.0	218.6
Average shift · longest shift	8h 14m · 9h 10m	8h 16m · 9h 00m
Closing shift: weekday · Saturday · Sunday	8h 40m · 9h 10m · 8h 55m	8h 10m · 8h 40m · 8h 10m
Full weekends off, about a year	10	14
Most days worked in a row	7 (up to 9)	5 (up to 6)
Shortest gap between two shifts	12h 30m	14h 35m
Different shift times	18	15 (8 you know)
On duty weekday · Saturday · Sunday	11–12 · 10 · 8	15 · 14 · 10
Avoidable fatigue warnings in the fixed rota	4 (up to 5)	0

Same hours and days, shorter closers, more full weekends off.



What happens next

1. Look at the full proposal sheet — page 3 shows every week of the link
2. Tell us what worries you, even if it is small
3. Your feedback goes to the managers with the proposal

Even Keel · EK-26-H1 · every figure worked out from the rota by the Marylebone Roster app